

Today he passed by me in the hallway and said something in passing.
It wasn't directed at me. I don't think he even saw me. But the
words stopped me cold.

"She always took the long way home. Guess she liked the quiet."

It was the same sentence.

Not verbatim. But the shape of it.
The tone. The grin that followed.

Beril had once said,

"He knew which streets I'd take. I never told anyone. But I changed
my route. Then I changed it again."

I never asked her what exactly he said. She didn't want to repeat
it.

Now I don't need her to.

I've heard it.

And it came out of R-3's mouth like it belonged there. Like it had
waited years for an echo.

So here we are.

I know who he is.
He doesn't know I know.
She doesn't know I know.
And now I'm the one who doesn't know what to do.

Can't prove it.
Can't confront him.
Can't tell her.

So the knowledge sits here. Between this line and the next.

And like everything else I've buried in this folder, it waits.

Label "R-3" remains.
But I don't need the code anymore.
I have the name.

I just won't write it.

— 0